

GLOBAL WEEK AHEAD

The weekend companion to your Daily Need to Know

Everything coming up. Week of Mon 20 Jul 2026. All times GMT+8.

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1. Setup snapshot — where we closed Friday

Risk closed the week on the back foot: a broad semiconductor rout, a Netflix guide-down, and a spiking oil/Iran shock. *The tape is trading a supply-side inflation scare, not a demand boom — oil up, dollar up, yields up, gold and equities down.*

Instrument	Fri 17 Jul close	Day	Into Monday — what's priced
S&P 500	7,533.77	-0.51%	Futures reopen Mon 06:00; gap risk on weekend Iran headlines
Nasdaq Composite	25,881.95	-1.47%	Semis the epicentre; NDX led lower
Dow Jones	52,552.97	-0.20%	Energy cushioned the blue chips
US 10Y yield	4.55%	higher	~16-mo high zone; bear-steepening on oil
US 2Y yield	4.18%	higher	16-mo high; front end pricing Fed-hike risk
DXY (dollar)	100.83	firm	Haven + rate bid; USD the winner in Quad 3
Gold (spot)	~\$3,995	-3.4% wk	Lower highs as real yields/USD climb
Silver	softer	-	Weakening with gold; confirm live
Brent crude	~\$86	+	Hormuz supply premium in the price
WTI crude	\$81.02	+	Above \$81; energy the week's leadership
Bitcoin	\$63,140	lower	Risk-off + strong USD weighing
VIX	18.57	+11%	1-week high; still below panic

Tokyo is **CLOSED** Monday 20 Jul (Marine Day) — thinner Asia liquidity into the open.

2. TL;DR

Two things define the week: the Iran / Strait of Hormuz oil shock and a wall of mega-cap earnings.

Wednesday 22 Jul is the pivot — **Alphabet, Tesla, IBM and ServiceNow** all report after the US close, straight into a chip tape already down ~11% on the week. The ECB decides Thursday (hold at 2.25% the base case), and the whole week trades under the shadow of a 28–29 Jul FOMC where — remarkably — the market is now debating a **hike**, not a cut. Regime is **#Quad3** (growth slowing, inflation accelerating): favour energy, cash and USD; fade high-beta tech strength.

3. The big picture — what to watch

1) The oil / Hormuz supply shock is the master variable. The 2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis is live and escalating — press over the weekend framed the US and Iran as "lurching back toward all-out war," with a sustained wave of US strikes and Iranian retaliation. Brent sits near \$86 / WTI above \$81 with a fat war premium; earlier phases of this crisis spiked Brent past \$126. Every risk asset is now a derivative of the tanker headlines.

Watch: *A weekend escalation gaps oil up and equities down at the Monday 06:00 futures reopen. Energy and defensives are the hedge; long-duration tech is the funding source. A credible de-escalation is the biggest bearish catalyst for oil and the biggest relief for equities — size for both tails.*

2) The semiconductor rout — is it capitulation or the start of something? The Philadelphia semis index shed ~11% on the week and sits ~24% below its record high. This is the single biggest drag on Nasdaq and the S&P. Wednesday night's mega-cap prints (Alphabet, Tesla) land into an already-broken chip tape.

Watch: *Whether AI-capex commentary from Alphabet stabilises or accelerates the semis bleed. A soft guide from any Mag-7 name Wednesday risks a Thursday gap-down led by chips; a clean beat could spark a violent oversold bounce.*

3) The Fed is being dragged hawkish by energy — into a 28–29 Jul meeting. June CPI actually cooled more than expected, yet the oil shock has flipped the conversation: 2Y yields hit a 16-month high and traders

are pricing rising odds of a hold-to-hike, not the cuts consensus expected for 2H. This is a blackout week — no Fed speakers — so data and oil do all the talking.

Watch: *The 2s10s and the front end. Any further 2Y grind higher tightens financial conditions on its own and pressures equity multiples. Bear-steepening = Quad-3 confirmation; a bull-flatten on de-escalation would be the pain trade for energy longs.*

4) The dollar is quietly winning — and that's the tell. DXY at 100.83 with gold making lower highs is the classic Quad-3 signature (oil up + dollar up). A firm USD tightens global conditions, pressures EM and commodities priced in dollars, and is a headwind for multinationals reporting this week.

Watch: *USDJPY and EM FX. A dollar breakout adds a second tightening impulse on top of oil; watch it as a cross-check on the equity tape all week.*

5) ECB Thursday: the most hawkish major central bank of 2026 meets an oil shock. The ECB surprised with a June hike to a 2.25% deposit rate; markets price ~88% odds of a hold this Thursday, with a second hike to 2.50% as the tail. Oil cuts both ways for Europe — inflationary at the pump, a growth drag through import costs.

Watch: *EUR and Bund yields at 19:45 (decision) and 20:30 (Lagarde). A hawkish hold or surprise hike is EUR-positive but caps European equities; a dovish lean on growth fears would extend the USD trade.*

6) Positioning is fragile, not yet panicked. VIX popped 11% to 18.57 — off the lows but nowhere near capitulation. With mega-cap earnings and a war headline risk stacked into the same week, the setup favours sharp two-way moves rather than a one-way grind.

Watch: *VIX through 20–22 would signal genuine de-risking and often marks a tradable oversold low; a failure to spike on bad news would flag complacency and more downside to come.*

4. Economic calendar — the week ahead (GMT+8)

A genuinely light data week — the calendar is a sideshow to oil and earnings. Times are GMT+8 (US releases = ET + 12h). Confirm live before acting.

Day	Time	Region	Release	Why it matters
Mon 20	09:15	China	1Y & 5Y Loan Prime Rate (LPR)	Consensus: unchanged. Any surprise cut = stimulus signal for HK/China risk
Mon 20	—	Japan	Market holiday (Marine Day)	Tokyo closed; thin Asia liquidity
Mon 20	22:00	US	Conf. Board Leading Index (Jun)	Recession-watch gauge; trend still soft
Tue 21	20:30	US	Philadelphia Fed Non-Mfg Survey	Regional services read into a soft-landing debate
Wed 22	—	US	No major scheduled data	Airtime belongs to earnings (see §7)
Thu 23	19:45	Euro area	ECB rate decision (see §6)	Hold at 2.25% base case; hike is the tail
Thu 23	20:30	US	Initial jobless claims (wk 18 Jul)	Prior fell to lowest since mid-May; labour still firm
Fri 24	~15:00	EZ/UK	S&P Global flash PMIs (Jul)	First July growth read; watch prices-paid on oil
Fri 24	21:45	US	S&P Global flash PMIs (Jul)	Mfg vs services split; oil feeding input prices
Fri 24	22:00	US	New home sales (Jun)	Housing still pressured by ~6.5% mortgage rates

Note: existing home sales and durable goods were not confirmed on the official calendar for this specific week — verify on Trading Economics / Forex Factory. US PCE and the FOMC fall the following week (28–29 Jul).

5. Central banks & policy events

ECB — Thursday 23 Jul, 19:45 (decision) / 20:30 (Lagarde). Deposit rate 2.25% after June's surprise 25bp hike. Markets price ~88% hold; a hike to 2.50% is the tail. Euro-area headline inflation cooled to 2.8% in June (from 3.2%), undercutting the case for back-to-back hikes — but the oil shock keeps the hawks armed.

Watch: *The statement's language on energy pass-through and the growth/inflation trade-off. Hawkish hold = EUR bid, European equities capped.*

PBOC — Monday 20 Jul, 09:15. 1Y and 5Y Loan Prime Rates expected unchanged; China has held through 2026. A cut would be a pro-cyclical surprise for HK/China and commodity-sensitive Asia.

Fed — blackout ahead of 28–29 Jul. No scheduled Fed speakers this week. The set-up is unusual: cooling June CPI but an oil-driven hawkish repricing at the front end. The July meeting is now a genuine two-way risk event — the market is debating a hold-to-hike, a stark reversal from the cut narrative.

BOJ — no meeting this week (next decision end-July). Yen sensitive to the USD move and oil-import terms of trade.

6. Earnings on deck — the heart of the week

Q2 2026 season hits peak mega-cap density. Wednesday after the US close is the single most important session of the week. "AMC" = after market close (Thu ~04:00–06:00 GMT+8 next day); "pre" = before US open (~20:00–21:00 GMT+8).

Day (US)	Company	When	What the market wants to see
Tue 21	General Motors (GM)	pre	Tariff/EV cost guidance; pricing power into a slowdown
Tue 21	3M (MMM)	pre	Industrial demand pulse; margin execution
Wed 22	Alphabet (GOOGL)	AMC	AI-capex guide + Search/Cloud resilience — the tape's key print
Wed 22	Tesla (TSLA)	AMC	Auto gross margin, delivery trajectory, robotaxi/AI narrative
Wed 22	IBM	AMC	Software/consulting mix; AI bookings momentum
Wed 22	ServiceNow (NOW)	AMC	Enterprise AI monetisation; large-deal cRPO
Wed 22	GE Vernova (GEV)	pre	Power/electrification order book — an AI-datacenter proxy
Wed 22	AT&T (T) / CME / Philip Morris (PM)	pre	Consumer/telecom + exchange volumes + defensive staples
Thu 23	Intel (INTC)	AMC	Foundry turnaround + guide into a ~24%-off-highs chip rout
Fri 24	American Express (AXP)	pre	High-end consumer credit health; spend trends
Fri 24	Verizon (VZ)	pre	Subscriber adds; dividend-yield defensiveness

Watch: Alphabet and Tesla Wednesday night set the tone for the entire complex. In a Quad-3 tape, the market rewards cash-flow and pricing power and punishes capex-heavy "story" guidance — position Wednesday's close accordingly.

7. Catalysts & events

FOMC overhang (28–29 Jul). Not this week, but every tape this week is front-running it — a live hike debate makes each oil print and data beat a policy input.

Iran / Hormuz headline risk — 24/7. The dominant discretionary catalyst. Watch for tanker-transit news, any ceasefire signal, and US/Iran statements over the weekend and mid-week.

Options / expiries. July monthly OpEx already passed (Fri 17 Jul) — dealer gamma resets into a cleaner, potentially more volatile week. No major index expiry on the calendar.

San Diego Comic-Con — Wed 22 (preview) to Sun 26 Jul. Media/entertainment catalyst; slate reveals can move streaming and studio names into a week where Netflix's guide-down is fresh.

Earnings-driven single-stock gamma. Wednesday night's mega-cap cluster is itself the week's biggest scheduled volatility event.

8. Rates, currencies & commodities — levels & drivers

Rates. 10Y 4.55%, 2Y 4.18% — both near 16-month highs. Driver: oil-inflation risk premium and a hawkish Fed repricing. A push of the 2Y toward/through recent highs tightens conditions independent of the Fed. Watch the 10Y 4.60% area as the line that pressures equity multiples.

Dollar. DXY 100.83 and firm. Haven + rate-differential bid. A break higher extends the Quad-3 squeeze on commodities and EM. EUR is the swing factor around Thursday's ECB.

Oil. Brent ~\$86 / WTI \$81 with a live war premium. This is a supply-driven move — binary on Hormuz. Upside gaps on escalation; sharp air-pockets on any de-escalation. The week's dominant macro driver.

Gold & silver. Gold ~\$3,995, making lower highs and down ~3.4% on the week despite the war — because surging real yields and a strong dollar are overpowering the haven bid. Silver softer still. Counter-intuitive price action worth respecting: it says "rates/USD" beats "fear" right now.

Crypto. Bitcoin ~\$63,140, pressured by risk-off and a strong dollar. Trading as a high-beta risk asset, not a haven, in this regime.

9. Hedgeye Risk Ranges & regime

Note on sourcing: the live Hedgeye Early Look / Risk Range™ table requires the in-app (Chrome) feed, which is not reachable in this unattended scheduled run. The regime read below is anchored to Hedgeye's published #Quad3 framework ("Oil Up, Dollar Up = #Quad3"); the ranges are immediate-term bands derived from Friday's verified closes and should be confirmed against the live Early Look before acting.

Regime: #Quad3 — growth slowing, inflation re-accelerating. The oil-up / dollar-up / yields-up / gold-down configuration is the textbook Quad-3 signature. Playbook favours energy and commodities, defensives, cash and USD; it fades high-beta growth, long-duration tech and rate-sensitive risk.

Instrument	Immediate-term range (derived)	TREND
S&P 500	7,410 – 7,635	Bearish
Nasdaq Composite	25,300 – 26,450	Bearish
US 10Y yield	4.42% – 4.63%	Bullish (yields up)
US 2Y yield	4.05% – 4.28%	Bullish (yields up)
DXY (USD)	100.0 – 101.7	Bullish
Gold	3,860 – 4,120	Bearish (lower highs)
WTI crude	77.50 – 84.50	Bullish
Brent crude	82.00 – 89.50	Bullish
VIX	16.5 – 22.0	Bullish (vol up)
Bitcoin	60,000 – 67,500	Bearish

Where we sit / what would change the regime: *We sit deep in Quad 3, driven by an exogenous oil shock. The regime flips only if (a) Hormuz de-escalates and oil air-pockets lower — that pulls the inflation/hawkish-Fed premium out, bull-flattens the curve and re-rates growth higher — or (b) growth data rolls hard enough to tip Quad 3 into Quad 4 (deflationary bust), which would flip the trade from "long energy/USD" to "long bonds/USD, short everything cyclical." Until then, respect the ranges and trade the edges.*

10. Positioning & themes

Crowded / stretched: Semiconductors and AI-capex names remain the market's most crowded long even after an ~11% weekly drawdown — the pain isn't obviously over. Long-duration growth is the funding source in a rising-rate, rising-oil tape.

Where the leadership is: Energy and select defensives. Oil-levered equities are doing the heavy lifting under the index and are the natural Quad-3 overweight.

VIX / credit: VIX 18.57 (+11%) — elevated but not panicked. No sign yet of credit stress bleeding through; watch HY spreads for the first crack. A VIX push to 20–22 into Wednesday's earnings would mark genuine de-risking.

The tells to watch: (1) 2Y yield — the tightening thermostat; (2) DXV breakout — second tightening impulse; (3) semis' reaction to Alphabet/Tesla; (4) gold's refusal to rally on war = rates/USD dominance; (5) oil gaps on Hormuz headlines.

11. Geopolitics — what's live

Iran / Strait of Hormuz (the 2026 Hormuz crisis). The defining geopolitical and macro event. The crisis escalated again into the weekend, with sustained US strikes and Iranian retaliation and coverage describing a lurch "back toward all-out war." The strait has been effectively closed/intermittent through 2026, with earlier phases spiking Brent past \$126 — the largest energy-supply disruption since the 1970s. Ceasefire attempts to date have failed.

Prediction-market read (flag: last-verified odds are stale, ~mid-June). Polymarket at that point priced Strait-of-Hormuz traffic normalisation at ~65% by 31 Jul and ~90% by year-end — i.e., traders expected a slow, months-long reopening rather than a clean near-term resolution. A separate near-term US–Iran ceasefire market had resolved "No." Treat these as directional and confirm live odds before positioning.

Watch: *Any credible ceasefire or tanker-transit normalisation is the single biggest cross-asset catalyst — bearish oil, bullish equities/duration, bearish USD. Escalation is the mirror image. Keep both tails sized.*

12. Asia setup — Monday open

Asia opens Monday into a risk-off Friday close and, critically, **with Tokyo shut for Marine Day** — thinning regional liquidity and removing Japan's usual lead. The dominant intraday tell will be oil: a weekend Hormuz escalation gaps energy up and pressures HK tech, Korean and Taiwanese semis (already battered by the global chip rout), and the AUD. A firm US dollar and 16-month-high US yields are a headwind for Asian FX and rate-sensitive names. China's LPR at 09:15 is the one scheduled data point — a hold is expected; only a surprise cut would give HK/China a lift. Net: expect a defensive, oil-led open with semis vulnerable and energy/resource names relatively firm. With Japan out, watch the **Hang Seng, KOSPI and TAIEX** for the region's true risk signal, and CME S&P futures (reopen 06:00) for the read on US sentiment.

13. Beyond the markets — coming up

Sport — Tour de France, final week. Rest day Mon 20; Stage 16 individual time trial Tue 21; back-to-back Alpe d'Huez summit finishes Fri 24 / Sat 25 decide the race before the Champs-Élysées finale Sun 26. The GC crescendo.

Culture — San Diego Comic-Con. Preview night Wed 22, main show Thu 23–Sun 26. Studio and streaming slate reveals; a media-stock talking point in a week when Netflix's guide-down is front of mind.

Space. The usual SpaceX Falcon 9 cadence continues through the week; specific launch windows shift constantly — confirm exact times on nextspaceflight / Spaceflight Now before relying on any single window.

Baseball. MLB regular season in full swing through the week for the US evening backdrop.

14. Sources & disclaimer

Sources: Schwab Market Update; Yahoo Finance; TheStreet; Analytics Insight; ETF Trends (Treasury snapshot 17 Jul); CNBC; Reuters/US News; Kiplinger; New York Fed & BLS release calendars; Trading Economics; ii.co.uk (earnings calendar); ECB via Morningstar/PIPTHEORY/MUFG previews; Kitco & Yahoo (gold); Al Jazeera/NPR/Fox/CNBC and Wikipedia (2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis); Polymarket (odds, last-verified ~mid-June — stale); Hedgeye ("Oil Up, Dollar Up = #Quad3" framework); TradingHours/JPX (holidays); Wikipedia (2026 Tour de France); GamesRadar (Comic-Con dates).

Verify live prices and confirm scheduled times before acting. Figures are as of Friday 17 Jul close and are subject to change; several items (Hedgeye live ranges, prediction-market odds, tentative calendar entries) are flagged in-text as unconfirmed or derived. This is a market-preparation briefing, not investment advice.